

NOVA.AI

Talent Acquisition

RECRUITMENT & HIRING GUIDE

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1. Purpose & Scope

This guide standardizes how Nova.ai sources, evaluates, and hires talent across Engineering, AI Research, Product, Sales, Customer Success, Finance, HR, and IT. It applies to all full-time, part-time, and contract hiring, and is binding on hiring managers, interviewers, and the Talent Acquisition (TA) team.

2. Requisition & Approval

Every hire begins with a Job Requisition raised by the hiring manager in the ATS (Applicant Tracking System), including role level, budget band, and business justification. Requisitions for new headcount (not backfills) require Head of Department and Finance approval before sourcing begins; backfills require hiring manager and HRBP sign-off only.

3. Sourcing Channels

- **Internal job board** — posted for a minimum 5 working days before external sourcing, giving internal candidates first consideration under the Internal Mobility policy.
- **Employee referrals** — incentivized under the Referral Bonus programme (Employee Handbook, Section 5.4); referred candidates are guaranteed a response within 5 working days.
- **Campus hiring** — annual drives at partner institutes for entry-level Engineering and AI Research roles, coordinated by TA with department mentors.
- **External job boards & agencies** — used for specialized or senior roles, via pre-approved recruitment agency panel only.

4. Standard Interview Process

All candidates progress through a structured, multi-stage process. Stage order may be adapted for senior or specialized roles with TA approval, but no stage may be skipped without documented justification.

Stage	Focus	Typical Owner
1. Resume Screen	Role-fit, experience, ATS keyword match	TA / Recruiter
2. Recruiter Screen (30 min)	Motivation, logistics, compensation expectations	TA / Recruiter
3. Technical / Functional Round	Role-specific skills assessment or take-home task	Hiring Manager / Panel
4. Case Study / System Design	Applied problem-solving (Engineering, AI Research, Product)	Senior IC / Lead
5. Panel / Bar-Raiser Round	Cross-functional evaluation against competency framework	Independent Panelist
6. Final / Culture Round	Values alignment, team fit	Department Head

5. Structured Scoring

Every interviewer submits an independent scorecard in the ATS within 24 hours of the interview, rating the candidate on defined competencies (technical depth, problem-solving, communication, values alignment) on a 4-point scale, with mandatory written justification for each score. Interviewers must not view other panelists' scores before submitting their own, to avoid anchoring bias.

6. Hiring Decision & Debrief

A hiring debrief is convened within 2 working days of the final interview, chaired by the hiring manager. A hire requires no “strong no” scores from any panelist; a single “strong no” triggers a mandatory discussion before proceeding, and the Bar-Raiser panelist holds override authority to block a hire on values-fit grounds alone.

7. Reference & Background Checks

A minimum of 2 professional references are verified for all roles, and 3 for Manager-level and above. Background verification (education, employment history, criminal record check) is conducted by an empanelled third-party vendor and must be cleared before an offer is finalized as “joining confirmed,” though a conditional offer may be extended pending results.

8. Offer & Negotiation

Offers are generated from the approved compensation band for the role level; any deviation beyond 10% above band requires Head of Department and HR Head approval. Verbal offers are always followed by a written offer letter within 2 working days, valid for acceptance within 7 calendar days unless otherwise agreed.

Fair Hiring Commitment

Nova.ai evaluates every candidate solely on role-relevant competencies. Hiring panels must include at least one member from a different function or gender than the hiring manager (Employee Handbook, Section 9.3), and all scorecards are retained for 12 months to support audit and calibration.

9. Onboarding Handoff

On offer acceptance, TA triggers the onboarding workflow: IT asset provisioning, system access requests, and Day-1 scheduling, per the IT Onboarding Guide. New hires receive their offer letter, this guide's candidate-facing summary, and a welcome email at least 5 working days before their start date.

10. Related Documents

Employee Handbook (Ch. 3, Employment Lifecycle) · IT Onboarding Guide · Performance Management Policy · Code of Conduct (Section 3, Anti-Discrimination).

This is a synthetically generated sample policy document created for demonstration and RAG-project portfolio purposes. It does not represent an actual company policy.